

American Pie -- Don McLean

From *American Pie* (1971). About 138 BPM for the band sections, est.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

A warm early-70s folk-rock bass that follows the changes with melodic walk-ups. It gets more active and driving as the song builds.

Built from the song's overall sound. I haven't verified the exact bass rig on the record.

Fingers over the neck. P pickup dominant. Tone knob around 45%.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg115 IR (User IR 1)

The B-15 is the early-70s studio bass sound: warm, round, and woody.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 10.

Low.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 36, VOL: 58.

Even walk-ups.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 18, Blend: 20, VOL: 55, Bass: 52, Treble: 48.

A hint of hair for the bigger, driving later verses. Blend 20.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 22, Bass: 58, Middle: 52, MidFreq: 450Hz, Treble: 40, VOL: 65.

Warm, round.

CAB -- User IR 1 (Apg115), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

Warm with a touch of 800Hz so walk-ups read.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Dry 70s rhythm section.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Bass OD, hint).

- **CTL off** -- Early verses. Warm, round, melodic. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- The driving later verses and final choruses. A hint of push.

Engage once the band really digs in, around the "Jack be nimble" section, and hold it through the big choruses.